

Semi positive polarity items*

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1. Introduction

Polarity items are commonly divided into two classes: Negative Polarity Items (NPIs) and Positive Polarity Items (PPIs) (Baker 1970). NPIs are acceptable in negative sentences, but unacceptable in positive declarative sentences. On the other hand, PPIs are unacceptable in the scope of negation, but acceptable in positive declarative sentences.

I argue that an additional class of polarity items should be recognized, which I propose to call Semi-PPIs. Like PPIs, Semi-PPIs can occur in positive declarative sentences. Unlike PPIs, these items may also occur in the scope of negation, but only if negation overtly precedes them. When Semi-PPIs precede negation, they have to take wide scope.

The primary example considered in this paper of the proposed class of Semi-PPIs is Hebrew *kol* ‘all’. *kol* can freely scope below negation from post-negative position and does not appear to be polarity sensitive (1).

- (1) a. kol ha-studentim avru et ha-mivxan.
all the-students passed ACC the-exam
‘All of the students passed the exam.’
b. lo kol ha-studentim avru et ha-mivxan.
NEG all the-students passed ACC the-exam
‘Not all of the students passed the exam.’ [✓NEG>*kol*]

On the other hand, when *kol* precedes negation, it has to take wide scope with respect to negation. For example, (2) does not have a reading where *kol* is in the scope of negation, which would be equivalent to (1b).

- (2) kol ha-studentim lo avru et ha-mivxan.
all the-students NEG passed ACC the-exam

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‘None of the students passed the exam.’

[*kol*>NEG ; *NEG>*kol*]

However, results of a corpus study indicate that there are three contexts in which *kol* can scope below negation from pre-negative subject position: (i) when the entire clause is embedded under an NPI licenser; (ii) when certain elements scopally intervene between negation and *kol*; (iii) when the sentence is an emphatic denial of a previous similar utterance.

In (3), the clause is embedded in an antecedent of a conditional, and the sentence is ambiguous¹ In (4), the adverb *behexreax* ‘necessarily’ acts as an intervener, so that *kol* is not in the immediate scope of negation. (5) is an example of emphatic denial.

- (3) im kol ha-studentim lo avru et ha-mivxan, ...
 if all the-students NEG passed ACC the-exam
 ‘If not all of the students passed the exam, ...’ [✓*if*>NEG>*kol*]
- (4) kol ha-studentim lo behexreax avru et ha-mivxan.
 all the-students NEG necessarily passed ACC the-exam
 ‘Not necessarily all of the students passed the exam.’ [✓NEG>*necessarily*>*kol*]
- (5) A: kol ha-studentim avru et ha-mivxan.
 all the-students passed ACC the-exam
 ‘All of the students passed the exam.’
- B: lo naxon! kol ha-studentim lo avru et ha-mivxan.
 NEG true all the-students NEG passed ACC the-exam
 ‘That’s not true! Not all of the students passed the exam.’ [✓NEG>*kol*]

I argue that the contexts that allow *kol* to scope below negation from pre-negative subject position are exactly those contexts which Szabolcsi (2004) identifies as allowing PPIs to occur in the scope of negation (see §2). And yet, *kol* is not a PPI, since it can freely occur in the scope of negation in post-negative position (1b). I propose that *kol* belongs to a previously undescribed class of polarity items – Semi-PPIs.

Szabolcsi analyzes PPIs as endowed with two NPI features, which are not active unless the PPI is in the scope of negation. I propose that Semi-PPIs have only one inactive NPI feature. This accounts for the similarity and differences between PPIs and Semi-PPIs.

This paper is structured as follows: In §2, I give an overview of the distributions of NPIs and PPIs and introduce the analysis in Szabolcsi (2004), which provides a unified account of the two classes. In §3, I present the results of a corpus study on the distribution of Hebrew *kol*. I also identify similar items in other languages, including Dutch *iedereen* ‘everyone’ and Swedish *någon* ‘some(one), any(one)’, and argue that they are Semi-PPIs as well. In §4, I extend Szabolcsi’s analysis to Semi-PPIs. In §5, I present the classification of polarity items that emerges from this analysis. In addition, I compare the analysis proposed in this paper to Zeijlstra (2017), which analyzes Dutch *iedereen* as a regular PPI. The last section concludes the paper.

¹For brevity, I ignore the wide-scope reading of *kol*. However, this reading is always available.

2. Theoretical background

Since this paper introduces a novel class of polarity items, I provide definitions for previously proposed classes, so one can see how their properties relate to each other.

- (6) *Definition of NPI*: An NPI is an item that: (i) can co-occur with clausemate negation (i.e., negation in the same clause) in a declarative main clause; and (ii) cannot occur in a Positive Declarative Episodic ² (PDE) sentence.

English *ever* is an example of an NPI (7).

- (7) a. I haven't ever been to Paris.
b. *I have ever been to Paris.

Note that the definition in (6) states the necessary and sufficient conditions for an item to be considered an NPI. It leaves open whether a given NPI may occur in other environments, such as questions. For instance, Ladusaw (1980) proposes that NPIs such as *ever* are licensed in all Downward-Entailing (DE) environments. However, (Klima 1964:313) and many others note that not all NPIs have the same licensing conditions. Some NPIs have a narrower or a broader distribution than *ever*. Comparing the distributions of different NPIs requires having a definition that is general enough to capture what all members of the class have in common. This is what definition (6) attempts to do.

Zwarts (1998) distinguishes between weak NPIs such as *ever* (8) and strong NPIs such as *in weeks* (9).³ Weak NPIs are licensed in all DE environments, while strong NPIs are licensed only in anti-additive environments, which are a subset of DE environments.⁴

- (8) a. Nobody has ever visited this area. [anti-additive]
b. Few people have ever visited this area. [DE]
- (9) a. Nobody has visited this area in weeks. [anti-additive]
b. *Few people have visited this area in weeks. [DE]

The definition of PPI is almost a mirror-image of the definition of NPI.

²An episodic sentence is a sentence that relates a specific occurrence, e.g., *Today, John got into a fight with someone*. This is opposed to a generic sentence, which generalizes over such occurrences, e.g., *Every now and then, John gets into a fight with someone* (Carlson 1995:224).

³Hoeksema (2008) argues that this classification is far from exhaustive. Having examined the distribution of 18 NPIs in English and Dutch with respect to 9 environments, he identifies 12 types of licensing patterns. Several other patterns can be found in (Haspelmath 1997:76). Nonetheless, I make use of the binary distinction for the sake of simplicity.

⁴An operator *f* is **DE** iff for all *x, y* such that $x \Rightarrow y : f(y) \Rightarrow f(x)$. (Ladusaw 1980:112)

An operator *f* is **anti-additive** iff for all *x, y* : $f(x \vee y) = f(x) \wedge f(y)$. (Zwarts 1998:222)

- (10) *Definition of PPI:* A PPI is an item that: (i) cannot occur in the immediate scope of clausemate negation in a declarative main clause; and (ii) can occur in a PDE sentence.

English *some* is an example of a PPI. In (11), *some* cannot take narrow scope with respect to negation. (11) cannot mean *It is not the case that I told you something* (i.e., *I didn't tell you anything*), but can only mean *There is something that I didn't tell you*, where *some* is outside the scope of negation. Negation is said to LICENSE NPIs and ANTI-LICENSE PPIs.

- (11) I didn't tell you something. [some>NEG ; *NEG>some]

Following Baker (1970), Szabolcsi (2004) identifies three contexts where PPIs are acceptable in the scope of negation. First, PPIs can occur in the scope of negation if the entire clause is embedded under an NPI licenser, such as an antecedent of a conditional. This is called RESCUING, since the higher licenser rescues the otherwise illicit scope configuration [*NEG>PPI].

- (12) If we don't call someone, we're doomed. [✓if>NEG>some]

Second, PPIs can occur in the scope of negation when they are not in its immediate scope. In (13), *always* intervenes between negation and *some* and allows the PPI to occur in the scope of negation. This is called INTERVENTION or SHIELDING.

- (13) I don't always find something when I go thrifting. [✓NEG>always>some]

Finally, PPIs can occur in the immediate scope of negation when negation is an emphatic denial of a previous similar assertion (Baker 1970:169). Horn (1989:397) considers this to be an instance of metalinguistic negation. In (14), the speaker doesn't contradict the proposition *Chris managed to solve some of the problems*, which would mean that he solved none of the problems; rather, the speaker rejects the use of *some* due to the scalar implicature that Chris solved some, but not all, of the problems.

- (14) Chris didn't manage to solve SOME of the problems - he managed to solve ALL of them. (Horn 1989:370) [✓NEG>some]

PPIs vary in strength, just like NPIs (van der Wouden 1994). For example, English *some* is a weak PPI, which is antilicensed by negation (15a) and implicitly negative adverbs and predicates such as *without* (15b) and *deny*. Haspelmath (1997:122) observes that *some* is also unacceptable in comparatives. In (15c), *some* can only have specific reference, in which case it takes wide scope over the comparative operator. However, *some* is not antilicensed in weak-NPI contexts such as antecedents of conditionals (15d).

- (15) a. *I didn't say something. [*NEG>some]

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- b. *John solved the problem without some help from his boss. [**without*>*some*]
- c. John knew Bill better than someone. [**er*>*some*]
- d. If someone calls, tell me. [*✓if*>*some*]

In contrast, Dutch *allerminst* ‘not-at-all’ is a strong PPI, and it is unacceptable in all DE contexts (van der Wouden 1994:5).

The contexts that antilicense *some* (15) are also the contexts that license strong NPis such as *in weeks* (9) (van der Wouden 1997). Szabolcsi (2004:418) observes that the unavailable reading, in which *some* is in the immediate scope of negation [*NEG*>*some*], is rescued if the entire clause is embedded in a context where weak NPis such as *ever* (8) are licensed. In other words, *some* is antilicensed in strong-NPI contexts and rescued in weak-NPI contexts.

Szabolcsi (2004:429) proposes to account for these facts by treating PPIs as endowed with two dormant NPI features: a strong-NPI feature, which requires an anti-additive licenser, and a weak-NPI feature, which requires a DE licenser. These NPI features remain dormant unless activated by a strong-NPI licenser. Activation happens when the PPI is in the immediate scope of an anti-additive operator at Logical Form (LF). For example, in (16a) the PPI *some* is not in the scope of any such operator, and its NPI features remain dormant. (16b) has two possible LFs: one in which *some* takes narrow scope and another in which *some* takes wide scope. In the narrow-scope LF, negation activates both of *some*’s NPI features, but licenses only the strong-NPI feature. There remains an active unlicensed feature, and the sentence becomes unacceptable. On the other hand, if *some* takes wide scope, its features are not activated, so this reading remains available. In (16c), another NPI licenser is present (i.e., *surprised*), and it licenses the weak-NPI feature of *some*, which allows it to scope below negation (rescuing). In (16d), *always* intervenes between negation and *some* and prevents the activation of the dormant features (shielding).

- (16)
- a. John called someone.
 - b. John didn’t call someone. [*some*>*NEG* ; **NEG*>*some*]
 - c. I’m surprised that John didn’t call someone. [*✓surprised*>*NEG*> *some*]
 - d. John didn’t always call someone. [*✓NEG*>*always*>*some*]

3. Data

In this section, I discuss several items which I argue to be polarity sensitive. What these items have in common is that they may occur in both positive and negative sentences, but exhibit PPI-like behavior when overtly preceding negation. Yet these items do not fall under the definition of PPI in (10) and are not accounted for by the analysis in Szabolcsi (2004). In §4, I propose that these items belong to the previously undescribed class of Semi-PPIs.

3.1 Hebrew *kol* ‘all’

Below, I present the results of a corpus study which investigated the intended interpretation of sentences in which the universal quantifier *kol* ‘all’ occurs in subject position and precedes clausal negation. Its goal was to identify the contexts where an inverse-scope reading [NEG>*kol*] is available.⁵ 507 examples were randomly collected from several corpora of written Hebrew. Additional examples were informally collected from the web. The intended reading of each sentence was evaluated based on the surrounding context.⁶

Table (17) summarizes the frequencies of the three readings in the 507 examples that were found in corpora (web examples are not included in this count).

(17) *Frequencies of the three readings in corpora*

	Surface-scope	Inverse-scope	Collective	Unclear	Total
n	415	28	55	9	507
%	81.8%	5.5%	10.8%	1.7%	100%

The results indicate that the surface-scope reading is overwhelmingly the most common. The inverse-scope reading is uncommon, constituting only 5.5% of the results.

In Table (18), I compare the frequencies of the different readings by context. The categories are as follows: (i) declarative main clause; (ii) dependent clause where NPIs are not licensed (e.g., content clause, most types of relative and adverbial clauses); (iii) NPI context (e.g., question, emotive factive predicate); (iv) emphatic denial (metalinguistic negation); (v) intervention; (vi) sentence with a complex plural predicate (e.g., *think the same way*, or *have lunch together*).

(18) *Frequencies of the three readings by context*

	S-scope	I-scope	Coll	Unclear	Total
Declarative main clause	232	0	31	3	266
Other non-NPI context	143	0	16	2	161
NPI context	40	13	8	4	65
Emphatic denial	0	6	0	0	6
Intervention	0	1	0	0	1
Complex plural predicate	0	8	0	0	8
Total	415	28	55	9	507

The results indicate that inverse-scope is not available in a declarative main clause unless that clause is an emphatic denial of a previous similar assertion. Furthermore, it is not available in a dependent clause that is not embedded by an NPI licenser. For example,

⁵Tottie and Neukom-Hermann (2010:152) note that *all...not* sentences have three possible readings. For example, *All the bills don't amount to \$50* has the following readings: (i) Surface-scope - *No bill amounts to \$50*; (ii) Inverse-scope - *Not all the bills amount to \$50*; (iii) Collective - *All the bills taken together do not amount to \$50*.

⁶For details about the methodology and results of this corpus study, I refer the reader to Amiraz (2019)

inverse-scope is not available under predicates such as *say*, *know*, *think* and *realize*, nor in adverbial clauses of reason or time. On the other hand, inverse-scope is available in NPI contexts, when an intervener is present, and in sentences with complex plural predicates.⁷

Note that inverse-scope is available in exactly those contexts where PPIs can occur in the scope of negation (§2).

3.2 Similar items in other languages

Zeijlstra (2017:15-17) reports similar data for Dutch *iedereen* ‘everyone’. He observes that in declarative main clauses, only surface-scope is available (19a). However, if the clause is embedded under an NPI licenser, inverse-scope becomes available (19b). In addition, inverse-scope is available when an element such as *altijd* ‘always’ intervenes between negation and *iedereen*, and when negation is metalinguistic.

(19) *Dutch (Zeijlstra 2017:15-17)*

- a. Iedereen vertrok niet.
everybody left NEG
‘Nobody left.’ [iedereen>NEG ; *NEG>iedereen]
- b. Het verbaast me dat iedereen niet blijft.
it surprises me that everybody NEG stays
‘It surprises me that not everybody stays.’ [✓surprise>NEG>iedereen]

Swedish *någon* ‘some(one), any(one)’ also seems to behave like Hebrew *kol* and Dutch *iedereen*. It occurs in both positive (20a) and negative (20b) sentences and appears to be polarity neutral. However, in pre-negative subject position, *någon* cannot be interpreted in the scope of negation (20c). To convey this meaning, one has to use *ingen* ‘nobody’, which does not co-occur with clausal negation (Holmes and Hinchliffe 2013:200). Like other Semi-PPIs, *någon* has to overtly follow negation in order to scope below it.

(20) *Swedish (Mirjam Möller Nwadigo, p.c.)*

- a. Jag har sett någon.
I have seen INDF
‘I saw someone.’
- b. Jag har inte sett någon.
I have NEG seen INDF
‘I didn’t see anyone.’ [✓NEG>någon]
- c. Någon har inte sett mig.
INDF has NEG seen me
‘There is someone who didn’t see me.’ [någon>NEG ; *NEG>någon]

⁷I believe that complex plural predicates give rise to an inverse-scope interpretation for independent reasons. These cases are not considered in the analysis proposed in this paper and are left for future research.

Web examples indicate that if the entire clause is embedded in an antecedent of a conditional, *någon* can scope below clausemate negation even from pre-negative subject position (21). Further research is needed in order to determine what other contexts can rescue *någon*.

- (21) Om någon inte hjälper mig snart är jag död.
 if INDF NEG helps me soon am I dead
 ‘If nobody helps me soon, I’m dead.’⁸ [$\checkmark$ if > NEG > någon]

English *many* is another possible Semi-PPI. It may occur in both positive and negative sentences, but in pre-negative subject position, it has to take wide scope over negation. For instance, (22) cannot mean *Not many arrows hit the target*. However, *many* can take narrow scope from that position if the clause is embedded in an antecedent of a conditional (23).

- (22) Many arrows didn’t hit the target. (Jackendoff 1969:223) [*many* > NEG]
- (23) Considering that these several means of transport, and that other means, which without doubt remain to be discovered, have been in action year after year for tens of thousands of years, it would, I think, be a marvellous fact **if many plants had not thus become widely transported**.⁹ [$\checkmark$ if > NEG > many]

4. Analysis

I propose that *kol* and the similar items noted in the other languages above belong to the previously undescribed class of Semi-PPIs.

- (24) *Definition of Semi-PPI:* A Semi-PPI is an item that: (i) can occur in the immediate scope of clausemate negation in a declarative main clause, but only if the item overtly follows negation; and (ii) can occur in a PDE sentence.

The goal of the analysis is to account for the following facts: (i) PPIs and Semi-PPIs are rescued under NPI licensors; (ii) PPIs and Semi-PPIs can scope below clausemate negation when certain elements scopally intervene between negation and the polarity item; (iii) Semi-PPIs can freely scope below clausemate negation from post-negative, but not pre-negative, position (asymmetry). PPIs are bad in both positions (symmetry).

The asymmetry between pre-negative and post-negative position is reminiscent of certain NPIs. For example, English *any* can be licensed by clausemate negation in post-negative position (25a), but not in pre-negative position (25b).¹⁰ Similarly, Swedish *någon*

⁸<http://novell.nu/novell/och-har-ligger-jag-och-lipar-17#sthash.kh0KAiIO.dpbs>

⁹Darwin, Charles R. 1859. *On the origin of the species*. London: John Murray

¹⁰This generalization is not entirely accurate. Ross (1967) observes that in certain cases, *any* can precede negation if it is embedded in a subject subordinate clause, e.g., *That he had stolen anything was never proved*. I set aside such cases and consider only sentences in which *any* is the head of the phrase. For discussion of embedded *any*, see Uribe-Etxebarria (1995).

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‘some(one), any(one)’ can scope below clausemate negation from post-negative position (20b), but not from pre-negative position (20c).

- (25) a. I didn’t see anyone.
b. *Anyone didn’t see me.

Ideally, one would want to account for the asymmetry in Semi-PPIs by the same mechanism that is independently needed for certain NPIs. I add this to the goals of the analysis.

I propose that the analysis in Szabolcsi (2004) can be extended to Semi-PPIs if we assume that: (i) they have a single dormant weak-NPI feature; (ii) this feature needs to be c-commanded by its licenser at Phonetic Form (PF).

These two conditions capture the distribution of Hebrew *kol*. In positive sentences, the NPI feature remains dormant (26a). When c-commanded by negation at PF, the NPI feature is activated and licensed by negation (26b). In (26c), there is an LF in which *kol* reconstructs below negation, which activates the NPI feature, but cannot license it due to the c-command condition. Therefore, we only get the reading in which *kol* takes wide scope, and its NPI feature remains dormant.

- (26) a. kol ha-studentim avru et ha-mivxan.
all the-students passed ACC the-exam
‘All of the students passed the exam.’
b. lo kol ha-studentim avru et ha-mivxan.
NEG all the-students passed ACC the-exam
‘Not all of the students passed the exam.’ [✓NEG>*kol*]
c. kol ha-studentim lo avru et ha-mivxan.
all the-students NEG passed ACC the-exam
‘None of the students passed the exam.’ [*kol*>NEG ; *NEG>*kol*]

When another NPI licenser is present, it can license the activated feature of *kol* and rescue the unavailable reading. In the inverse-scope reading of (27), *kol* reconstructs below negation, which activates its feature, but does not license it. Then, the conditional licenses the activated feature, and the inverse-scope reading becomes available.

- (27) im kol ha-studentim lo avru et ha-mivxan, ...
if all the-students NEG passed ACC the-exam
‘If not all of the students passed the exam, ...’ [✓if>NEG>*kol*]

Intervention works the same way it does for PPIs. In (28), *behexreax* ‘necessarily’ intervenes between negation and *kol* and prevents negation from activating the dormant feature.

- (28) kol ha-studentim lo behexreax avru et ha-mivxan.
all the-students NEG necessarily passed ACC the-exam

‘Not necessarily all of the students passed the exam.’ [$\checkmark$ NEG>*necessarily*>*kol*]

Prima facie, this analysis is a natural extension of Szabolcsi (2004). If there are items with a single active NPI feature (e.g., *any*) and items with two dormant NPI features (e.g., *some*), we expect to find items with a single dormant NPI feature. However, Szabolcsi does not allow single NPI features to be dormant.

Following Postal (2004), Szabolcsi (2004:439-440) analyzes indefinites as containing invisible underlying negations. An NPI like *anyone* contains one invisible negation, and a PPI like *someone* contains two invisible negations. In other words, *someone* is underlyingly *not-not-someone*. When *someone* is not in the scope of negation, the two negations cancel out. This allows Szabolcsi to deconstruct the metaphor of dormant features. There is no need to assume a distinction between active and dormant features, because this distinction falls out from the number of NPI features the item has and the logical equivalence of $\neg\neg p = p$. It also follows that a single NPI feature cannot be dormant in this model. Since single dormant NPI features are a crucial component of the analysis proposed in this paper, I depart from Szabolcsi at this point and adopt an alternative approach to NPI features, proposed in Guerzoni (2006).

Guerzoni (2006:362) proposes that the polarity sensitivity of NPIs like *any* is “encoded in the form of a grammatical feature that needs to be checked at LF” by an appropriate licenser. The NPI carries the uninterpretable feature, and the licenser carries the interpretable feature. An NPI feature is considered to be similar in nature to a *wh*-feature. This approach is supported by the fact that NPIs are subject to locality constraints similar to those that affect *wh*-phrases, such as certain islands and interveners. For example, an NPI cannot be licensed in a Complex NP island (29). For further discussion of the commonalities between NPI-features and *wh*-features, see Guerzoni (2006).

- (29) a. *What_{*i*} did Mary meet the man who gave her *t_i*?
 b. *Mary didn’t meet the man who gave her any present. (Guerzoni 2006:364)

On this approach, an NPI feature is not considered an invisible negation, and dormancy cannot be a result of two negations canceling each other out. Instead, I assume that dormancy is parametric, and any NPI feature can have this property. This allows a single NPI feature to be dormant, but introduces an additional stipulation to the model. In Amiraz (2019), I justify this stipulation by showing that it makes correct predictions regarding Bipolar Items (see §5.1).

Finally, I argue that the c-command condition is independently needed for certain NPIs, such as *any*. Linebarger (1987:328) suggests that negation must c-command *any* in order to license it. (30a) is unacceptable because negation doesn’t c-command the NPI in the narrow-scope reading of *any* [NEG>*any*]. The wide-scope reading [*any*>NEG] is ruled out because *any* is not in the scope of an appropriate licenser. This analysis predicts that if the entire clause is embedded under an NPI licenser, both readings will become available, since that licenser c-commands *any* in both scope positions. This prediction is borne out, as shown in (30b), where the narrow-scope reading of *any* is intended.

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- (30) a. *Anyone didn't die. [$*\text{NEG} > \text{any}$; $*\text{any} > \text{NEG}$]
 b. We played flag football, (really tackle), basketball, indoor court hockey (it was a wonder how anyone didn't die) and a game he made up called "hocker."¹¹
 [$\checkmark \text{wonder} > \text{NEG} > \text{any}$; $\checkmark \text{wonder} > \text{any} > \text{NEG}$]

5. Further issues

5.1 A partial classification of polarity items

A fourth class of polarity items, first proposed in van der Wouden (1997:91-93), is Bipolar Items (BPIs). BPIs have the combined properties of NPIs and PPIs.

- (31) *Definition of BPI:* A BPI is an item that: (i) cannot occur in the immediate scope of clausemate negation in a declarative main clause; and (ii) cannot occur in a PDE sentence.

Dutch *ooit* 'ever' is an example of a BPI. It has a similar distribution to English *ever*, except that it cannot co-occur with clausemate negation (van der Wouden 1997:91-93).

The defining properties of the four classes of polarity items are shown in Table (32).

- (32) *Defining properties of the four classes of polarity items*

Context	NPI	PPI	BPI	Semi-PPI
The immediate scope of clausemate negation	✓	*	*	✓/*
Positive declarative episodic sentence	*	✓	*	✓

I derive the differences between the four classes of polarity items using two parameters: (i) number of NPI features; (ii) activeness of each of those features.¹² This is shown in Table (33), where [+npi(A)] denotes an active NPI feature, and [+npi(D)] denotes a dormant one. Variation within each class of items is accounted for using two additional parameters: (iii) strength of NPI features; (iv) requirement of c-command by licenser.

- (33) *A feature-based analysis of the four classes of polarity items*

NPI	Semi-PPI	PPI	BPI
[+npi(A)]	[+npi(D)]	[+npi(D), +npi(D)]	[+npi(A), +npi(D)]
English <i>ever</i>	Hebrew <i>kol</i>	English <i>some</i>	Dutch <i>ooit</i>

¹¹Page, Gregory J. 2014. *The tale of two champions*. Lulu.com.

¹²The crux of the analysis of BPIs in Amiraz (2019) is that BPIs have both an active and a dormant NPI feature. Due to their active feature, BPIs are unacceptable in PDE sentences. Due to their dormant feature, BPIs are also unacceptable with clausemate negation since negation activates the dormant feature. This analysis predicts that BPIs can be rescued if the clause is embedded under an NPI licenser. This prediction is borne out for Dutch *ooit* 'ever' (Hoeksema 1999:45) and other BPIs.

5.2 Comparison with Zeijlstra (2017)

Zeijlstra (2017) analyzes Dutch *iedereen* ‘everyone’, which is considered here a Semi-PPI, as a run-of-the-mill PPI. His analysis is framed in the exhaustification-based model of Chierchia (2006). In this model, an NPI like *any* is seen as an existential quantifier that obligatorily introduces subdomain alternatives and is exhaustified by an O operator, which is the covert equivalent of *only*. These two properties lead to contradiction whenever *any* is not in a DE context, and the sentence becomes unacceptable.

Zeijlstra notes that a universal quantifier with the same properties as *any* would be a PPI, due to the duality of existential and universal quantifiers. He argues that Dutch *iedereen* ‘everyone’ is a PPI, even though it can scope below negation when following it.

While NPIs are acceptable when a DE operator intervenes between the exhaustifier and the NPI (34a), PPIs are unacceptable in this configuration (34b). PPIs are acceptable when there is no DE operator or when they scope above the DE operator, e.g., when a PPI scopes above negation. However, Zeijlstra argues that a PPI is allowed to scope below a DE operator, as long as the exhaustifier is attached below that operator as well (34c).

- (34) a. $\checkmark \text{EXH} > \text{DE} > \text{NPI}$
 b. $*\text{EXH} > \text{DE} > \text{PPI}$
 c. $\checkmark \text{DE} > \text{EXH} > \text{PPI}$

Zeijlstra argues that when *iedereen* follows negation, the exhaustifier is below negation as well, and we get the licit configuration in (34c). But when *iedereen* precedes negation, the exhaustifier is attached above negation, and if *iedereen* reconstructs, we get the illicit configuration in (34b). The missing piece is why the position of the exhaustifier depends on the position of *iedereen*. Zeijlstra suggests the constraint in (35).

- (35) In any sentence with an NPI/PPI that needs to be checked by a covert exhaustifier, this exhaustifier must be present in a position where it c-commands the NPI/PPI at surface structure. (Zeijlstra 2017:12)

When *iedereen* follows negation, the exhaustifier can attach between negation and the PPI and still c-command *iedereen* at PF. On the other hand, when *iedereen* precedes negation, the exhaustifier has to attach above negation in order to obey the constraint in (35).

This analysis raises the following question: why is it not the case that all PPIs are acceptable in post-negative position? Zeijlstra argues that it has to do with the strength of the PPI: weak PPIs can have their exhaustifier in a low position, but strong PPIs have the exhaustifier in a high position at CP level, where it is always above negation.

Zeijlstra focuses mostly on modal PPIs, and it seems that extending this generalization to quantifiers over individuals is problematic. For instance, English *some* is a weak PPI (15). Therefore, this analysis falsely predicts it to be acceptable in the scope of negation when it occurs in post-negative position. It is unclear how we can avoid this prediction. It

seems that we would have to stipulate that some, and possibly most, PPIs idiosyncratically require that the exhaustifier be attached high.

Another concern is that this analysis cannot account for asymmetry in weak NPIs (e.g., **Anyone didn't see me*) by the same mechanism that it employs for the asymmetry of *iedereen* 'everyone'. NPIs are acceptable when the exhaustifier is above the DE operator (34a) and unacceptable when the exhaustifier is below it (36). In order to apply Zeijlstra's mechanism to NPIs, we have to say that: (i) when the NPI follows negation, the exhaustifier is attached high (34a); (ii) when the NPI precedes negation, the exhaustifier is attached low (36). These configurations run against the constraint in (35) and are unmotivated. It seems that we would have to tell a different story in order to account for the asymmetry between pre-negative and post-negative position in weak NPIs like *any*.

(36) *DE > EXH > NPI

Like the items considered in this paper as Semi-PPIs (see §3), *any* cannot scope below negation from pre-negative subject position, but this scope configuration can be rescued if the entire clause is embedded under an NPI licenser (30). Therefore, an analysis that provides a unified account for both cases is preferred. I argue that the c-command condition that has been proposed for NPIs can also apply to Semi-PPIs. This analysis is simpler, since it can apply to different classes of polarity items without requiring any adjustments.

6. Conclusion

In this paper, I proposed that Hebrew *kol* 'all' and similar items in other languages belong to a previously undescribed class of polarity items: Semi-PPIs. What sets Semi-PPIs apart from other classes of polarity items is that they may appear in both positive and negative sentences. However, they need to overtly follow negation in order to be interpreted in its scope. When preceding negation, Semi-PPIs behave like PPIs. I extended the analysis in Szabolcsi (2004) to Semi-PPIs by analyzing them as having a single dormant NPI feature, which needs to be c-commanded at PF by its licenser in order to be licensed. I argued that the c-command condition is independently needed for NPIs such as English *any*, which have to be c-commanded by negation in order to be licensed.

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